

“Look back at time ... before our birth. In this way Nature holds before our eyes the mirror of our future after death. Is this so grim, so gloomy?”

Here Lucretius points out that we are already familiar with times at which we do not exist: namely, all of those times before our birth. When you think about times before your birth, are you filled with horror? Lucretius thinks not. But then you should not fear times after your death, because those will be just the same.

Because this draws a kind of parallel between pre-birth and post-death times,
this is sometimes called the **symmetry argument**.

One can think of Luncratius' second argument as a reply to this objection.



“Look back at times before with In this way

Nature has been very kind to us

but after death. Is this grim, gloomy?

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